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LIFE OS

The Life OS Kit

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The Life OS Kit

Your life, running on a system — not on willpower

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1. What is a Life Operating System?

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File  |  What it holds
`dashboard.md`  |  Your command center — links, priorities, quick stats
`goals.md`  |  Yearly !’ quarterly !’ monthly goals with templates
`weekly-review.md`  |  The Friday review ritual
`habits.md`  |  Daily habit tracking on a 31-day grid
`finance.md`  |  Monthly budget with categories and formulas
`projects.md`  |  Active projects, next actions, waiting-on list
`reading-library.md`  |  Reading list + book notes
`journal.md`  |  Daily journal with prompts
`contacts-crm.md`  |  Personal CRM for relationships
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2. Why Templates Beat Apps

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3. Setup in Under an Hour

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Option A: Notion (recommended for most people)

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Option B: Obsidian (recommended if you want plain files and backlinks)

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Option C: Google Docs (for people who live in a browser)

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The 60-minute plan

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Minutes  |  Task
0–10  |  Pick your platform, create the container page/folder
10–30  |  Paste in all nine files
30–45  |  Fill `goals.md` for this year (one pass, not perfect)
45–55  |  Set up the habit grid for this month
55–60  |  Do your first weekly review with the `weekly-review.md` template
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4. How the Pieces Connect

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         %   DASHBOARD  %   !• you land here
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   % % % % % % % % % % % %<% % % % % % % % % % % %
   %¼            %¼            %¼
 GOALS       PROJECTS    HABITS
   %             %             %
   % % % % % %,% % % % % %4% % % % %,% % % % % %
         %¼           %¼
    WEEKLY REVIEW  JOURNAL
         %             %
         % % % % % %,% % % % % %
              %¼
        FINANCE + READING + CONTACTS
        (supporting files, reviewed monthly)
```

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- **Dashboard** links to everything and shows this week's focus. Open it daily.
- **Goals** is the "why" layer. Projects are the "what." Habits are the "how, every day."
- **Weekly review** is the engine. Everything else feeds into it or gets checked by it.
- **Journal** is the capture layer. Anything that pops into your head goes there first.
- **Finance, Reading, Contacts** are domain files. They get reviewed on their own
cadence (monthly for finance, weekly for reading, monthly for contacts).

## 5. The Weekly Review Ritual

The weekly review is the single most important habit in the entire system. It takes 20–
30 minutes, once a week, ideally Friday afternoon or Sunday evening.

1. **Clear the inbox.** Process every captured note in `journal.md` or your capture
area: turn each into a project, a habit, a goal, a contact note, or delete it.
2. **Review the week.** Open `weekly-review.md`. Fill in wins, misses, and the numbers
(habits %, projects moved, money spent vs. budget).
3. **Update the projects list.** Every active project needs exactly one *next action*.
No next action = it's stalled; reschedule it or kill it.
4. **Check habits.** Look at the 31-day grid. Identify the one habit that's slipping and
either shrink it or drop it. You cannot fix six habits at once.
5. **Set next week's focus.** Pick the ONE priority outcome for next week and write it
at the top of the dashboard.
6. **Look ahead.** Scan the calendar for the coming 7–14 days. Note travel, deadlines,
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birthdays (check `contacts-crm.md`), and money events.

If you skip reviews for two weeks straight, shrink the ritual until you'll actually do it. A 5-minute review beats a 45-minute review you never run.

6. Daily Rhythm (Optional but Powerful)

- **Morning (5 min):** Open dashboard. Read this week's focus. Pick today's top 3 from `projects.md` next actions.
- **Evening (10 min):** Journal entry in `journal.md`. Tick habits in `habits.md`. Quick check: did today move the weekly focus forward?

That's the whole system. Everything else is detail.

7. The 30-Day Launch Plan

If you're setting this up for the first time, don't try to use all nine files on day one. Run this sequence:

- **Week 1 — Capture only.** Use `journal.md` and `dashboard.md`. Nothing else. Get in the habit of writing things down instead of holding them in your head.
- **Week 2 — Add the engine.** Start `weekly-review.md`. Do your first real review this week. Add `projects.md` and move your top 3 projects in.
- **Week 3 — Add direction.** Fill `goals.md` for the year. Set this month's goals. Add `habits.md` with 3 habits max.
- **Week 4 — Add domains.** Bring in `finance.md` for your monthly budget, `reading-library.md` for whatever you're reading, and `contacts-crm.md` for the 10 people you want to stay closer to.

By day 30 you'll have the full system — or you'll know exactly which pieces you actually need.

8. Troubleshooting

"I set it all up and stopped using it after a week."
Almost always means the system is too heavy. Fix: cut to dashboard + weekly review only. Add files back one at a time, only when you feel the need. The kit is modular — use two files or all nine.

"My goals feel fake / I never hit them."
Check the goals file: are they outcomes or activities? "Exercise more" is an activity; "Run a 10K in May" is an outcome. Also check the review — are you actually reviewing monthly? Goals without reviews become decoration.

"I have too many projects and nothing gets done."
Cap active projects at 3–5. Everything else goes to a "Someday/Maybe" list. In `projects.md`, the rule is: **3 active projects max per life area** (work, health, personal). If a new project appears, one must graduate or pause.

"The habit grid is intimidating."
Track 3–5 habits, not 12. Start each habit at a trivially small version ("do 2 pushups" not "work out"). Consistency for 30 days beats intensity for 3.

"I use my phone, not a laptop."
Notion and Obsidian both have mobile apps. The weekly review can be done on your phone in 20 minutes. The daily journal prompt works as a phone note.

"Can I share this with my partner / team?"
Yes — duplicate the folder. Couples often run a shared `dashboard.md` and `finance.md` plus individual journals. Keep personal journals separate.

"I want paper."
All nine files print cleanly. The habit grid is designed for a 31-day monthly page. Print `habits.md` and `finance.md` monthly; keep the rest digital.

9. Making It Yours

After your first month, expect to edit. Common evolutions:

- Add a `health.md` if fitness dominates your life.
- Split `finance.md` into business vs. personal if you're self-employed.
- Add a `travel.md` if you take trips often.
- Create an `archive/` section and move completed goals/projects there monthly.

The system should feel like yours within 90 days. If it still feels like someone else's template, you're not editing it enough.